RESEARCH DOSSIER / PRECIOUS METALS

Who is buying gold?

Central-bank buyers, sellers and what drives a Singapore investor's return

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

321.2 t
Estimated Q3 official net buying

120 t
Publicly reported Q3 net buying

US$4,044.09
Spot per troy ounce · 6 Nov, 13:01 SGT

KEY FINDINGS

1. China and Poland led disclosed Q3 buying. Roughly 63% of total estimated demand cannot be attributed to named buyers.
2. A central bank may sell gold to raise currency, rebalance a portfolio or meet a policy obligation. The reason changes how to read the sale.
3. For Singapore investors, both the gold price and USD/SGD determine the unhedged return. Bank forecasts also have different dates and horizons.

Market snapshot · 6 November 2026, 13:01 SGT

THREE DIFFERENT CLOCKS

30 SEP
Official net buying
Q3 flows and period-end reserve volumes.

31 OCT
Gold fund flows
Month-end holdings and subscriptions.

6 NOV
Spot observation
Intraday US dollars per troy ounce.

CONTENTS

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CHAPTER 01 / OFFICIAL DEMAND

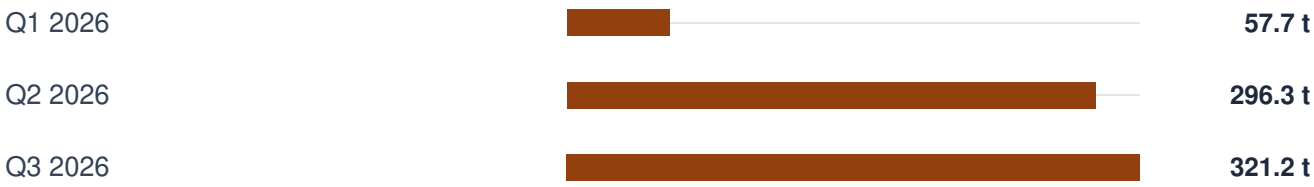
Central banks bought more gold as the price weakened

Official buyers stepped up sharply after a weak first quarter. The November data show a net 57.7 tonnes in Q1, 296.3 in Q2 and 321.2 in Q3. The last figure was 42% above a year earlier. Yet the World Bank reports that gold prices fell 5% from Q2 to Q3. A reserve manager can add to a holding while other investors sell enough to push the price down.

EXHIBIT 01.1

Official net purchases accelerated through 2026

Net metric tonnes by quarter · 3 November data release



Each bar starts at zero. Purchases less sales across central banks and other official institutions include estimated activity.

G1 World Gold Council / Metals Focus · G2 World Gold Council / Metals Focus

The estimate changed enough to alter the story of the year. The first Q1 release put buying at 244 tonnes. The Q2 release revised that sharply downward, and the November table puts it at 57.7. Combining April's Q1 estimate with November's Q2 and Q3 figures would exaggerate the level of demand and hide the rebound.

EXHIBIT 01.2

Price and purchasing moved in opposite directions

Q3 versus Q2 2026 · changes as published

Measure	Quarter-on-quarter change
Official gold demand	+8%
Gold price, World Bank review	–5%

The observations describe the same quarter. They do not measure the price effect of an individual purchase.

G1 World Gold Council / Metals Focus · W1 World Bank

CHAPTER 02 / HOW TO READ THE DATA

Who bought the remaining gold?

Public filings identify only part of Q3 buying. The World Gold Council puts disclosed net purchases at 120 tonnes, compared with roughly 321 tonnes after Metals Focus incorporates estimates. The gap covers late reporting and trades that never appear in time for publication. It cannot be reliably assigned to China, a Gulf state or another named buyer.

EXHIBIT 02.1

About 63% of Q3 net demand was unreported

Approximate decomposition · net metric tonnes · July–September 2026



Disclosed	**120 t**
Estimated remainder	**about 201 t**

The remainder uses source-rounded figures, 321 less 120. It has no reliable country-by-country breakdown.

G2 World Gold Council / Metals Focus

The answer to “is buying up this year?” depends on the series. For January to September, reported purchases fell 7% year on year to 228 tonnes. Estimated demand rose 6% to 675 tonnes. Both comparisons can be right because their coverage differs. A monthly change in disclosed reserves is evidence about that balance sheet, while imports can also reflect households, jewellers, banks and funds.

EXHIBIT 02.2

The reporting perimeter changes the year-on-year conclusion

January–September 2026 · net metric tonnes

Coverage	2026	Year on year
Publicly reported	228 t	–7%
Reported plus estimated	675 t	+6%

The two rows overlap. Adding them would count publicly reported activity twice.

G2 World Gold Council / Metals Focus · G3 World Gold Council / IMF IFS / national authorities

Sources G1 · G2 · G3

CHAPTER 03 / DISCLOSED BUYERS

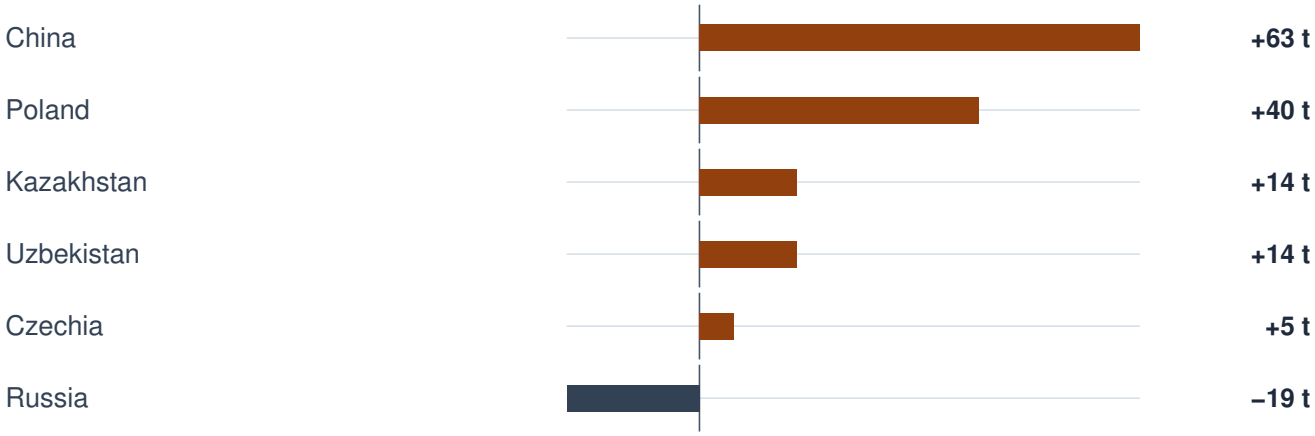
China picked up the pace as Poland approached its target

China added 63 tonnes in Q3, more than half its purchases for the first nine months. Its September statement gives a direct check on the quantity. Holdings rose by 740,000 ounces to 77.47 million ounces, the 23rd consecutive monthly increase. The announcement gives no price target or motive for that month's purchase.

EXHIBIT 03.1

Six disclosed changes show how concentrated buying was

Net tonnes, Q3 2026



Right of zero means a net addition. WGC's rounded figures put China and Poland together at 104 t on unrounded data, about 86% of reported net demand.

G2 World Gold Council / Metals Focus

Poland's governor confirmed on 5 November that reserves had reached the 700-tonne goal. Quarterly additions slowed from 51 tonnes in Q2 to 40 tonnes in Q3. He left open further purchases as overall reserves grow. The next indication of demand will come from the board's decision on how much gold to hold.

CHAPTER 03 / DISCLOSED BUYERS / CONTINUED

China picked up the pace as Poland approached its target

Uzbekistan illustrates how purchases can coexist with a willingness to sell. The central bank added 14 tonnes in Q3. Its governor had discussed selling at favourable prices as part of reserve management. A willingness to sell gives the bank flexibility and leaves the timing open.

EXHIBIT 03.2

Two approaches to reserve accumulation

Policy evidence available by 5 November 2026

Institution	What is confirmed	What to watch
Poland	700-tonne target reached, governor said on 5 Nov.	A new allocation decision or evidence of continued purchases.
Czechia	87.4 tonnes held at end-Sep. CNB aims for 100 tonnes by 2028.	Progress toward a stated target and any change in the mandate.

A public target provides a reference point. Actual purchases and their timing still depend on the institution.

C4 Reuters · C5 Czech National Bank

Sources G2 · C3 · C4 · C15 · C5

CHAPTER 04 / DISCLOSED SELLERS

Gold supplied cash when some official holders needed it

Russia's governor linked recent reductions mainly to the finance ministry's transactions under its fiscal rule. The National Wealth Fund holds assets that the ministry can use under that rule. The governor also cited metal used for coin production. The published explanation does not allocate the quarter's 19-tonne decline across those uses.

EXHIBIT 04.1

Three different kinds of reduction

Metric tonnes and observation windows shown

Institution	Observed change	Evidence for the explanation
Bank of Russia	–19 t in Q3	Governor identified fiscal-rule operations and minting in September.
Türkiye	–81 t Jan–Sep; +1 t in Sep	March swaps provided FX liquidity. A monthly addition can coexist with a year-to-date reduction.
Azerbaijan · SOFAZ	200.0 t at Dec 2025; 178.1 t in Mar and Sep 2026	Sovereign fund. Changes are calculated from its own period-end stocks.
Qatar, Kyrgyz Republic, UAE	Small Q3 reductions	WGC identified the declines. Individual motives were undisclosed.

Observation windows differ. SOFAZ reports quarterly and is excluded from WGC monthly totals. A period-end stock cannot reveal every intervening transaction.

G2 World Gold Council / Metals Focus · G3 World Gold Council / IMF IFS / national authorities · C8 Bank of Russia · C9 World Gold Council · C11 State Oil Fund of the Republic of Azerbaijan · C12 State Oil Fund of the Republic of Azerbaijan · C10 State Oil Fund of the Republic of Azerbaijan

Türkiye used gold to obtain foreign currency when demand for cash rose. In March, the central bank both disposed of metal and arranged gold-for-currency swaps. Under a swap, the bank agrees to reverse the exchange at maturity. Adding the swap amount to outright sales would overstate the gold permanently sold.

Azerbaijan's sovereign wealth fund reported the same gold stock in March and September. Its year-end to September holdings fell by 21.9 tonnes. The fund states its diversification policy and allocation limits. Its holdings disclosures leave the specific reason for the reduction open.

CHAPTER 05 / READING THE GLOBAL REGISTER

The largest vaults tell a different story from the largest buyers

A ranking by tonnes held answers who owns the stock today. The World Gold Council's register covers the top 100 disclosed holders and provides a separate file of changes. Most November entries refer to September, while some refer to June or earlier. The prior Hub report screened that roster. This update verifies selected moves and the cases below against their own disclosures.

EXHIBIT 05.1

Ownership, custody, exposure and a reported zero

Reference dates and instrument types shown

Case	What the source measures	How to read it
United States	Treasury owns US official gold. The New York Fed holds metal for multiple owners.	A change in foreign client custody does not establish a US purchase.
Canada	Finance Canada showed US$0m for gold on 30 Oct 2026.	The source reports a zero position at its published precision.
South Korea	679,765 SPDR Gold Trust shares at end-Jun. Separately, 104.4 t of physical reserves.	Count ETF shares as securities. A planned December domestic buying channel was still prospective.

The WGC top-100 register is linked in the sources. No entry or an old reporting date cannot establish zero activity.

C16 World Gold Council / IMF IFS / national authorities · C17 Federal Reserve · C18 Department of Finance Canada · C20 Reuters · C21 Reuters

Five legacy holders still account for about 52% of world gold reserves. Federal Reserve staff identify the United States, Germany, Italy, France and the IMF. Together they have added little since the 1970s. Their existing stock can rise by billions of dollars in value without producing a new purchase.

Gold can arrive in a country's vault without the country buying it. The New York Fed stores metal for official account holders. South Korea illustrates a different issue: owning units in a gold fund gives the central bank exposure to the price, while the central bank reports a separate monetary-gold stock.

Sources C16 · C17 · C18 · F1 · C20 · C21 · H1

CHAPTER 06 / HISTORICAL REVERSALS

Czechia rebuilt its stock while Switzerland held steady

Czechia reversed an earlier decision to sell most of its gold. The Czech National Bank resumed more active buying in 2023. Its own analysis found that a holding near 100 tonnes would make its financial results less sensitive to market swings. That explains the target from the perspective of this particular institution.

EXHIBIT 06.1

Read the verb before reading the tonnes

Historical reported stocks and stated goals

Case	Starting position	Later position	Meaning
Czechia	8 t at end-2019; about 12 t at end-2022	87.4 t in Sep 2026; target 100 t by 2028	A deliberate rebuild
Switzerland	1,040 t at end-2008	1,040 t in the SNB's current disclosure	Long-running hold
European agreement	Official sales coordinated from 1999	Agreement expired in Sep 2019	End of a sales framework

The Czech target is a future policy objective. The other stock figures refer to holdings that the institutions reported.

C5 Czech National Bank · C6 Swiss National Bank · C7 European Central Bank

The Swiss National Bank still holds the same 1,040 tonnes it held at the end of 2008. Its gold is stored in Switzerland, London and Canada to preserve access in a crisis. All three locations belong to the same Swiss stock. Counting the location of bars as a purchase would create a trade that never took place.

Europe's coordinated sales wound down before the agreement expired in 2019. The ECB said signatories had sold little for nearly a decade. A world in which legacy holders sell less and other reserve managers buy more can show net purchases even when few institutions reverse their own policy.

Sources C5 · C6 · C7

CHAPTER 07 / CASE STUDY · GHANA

A gold export programme can earn dollars and lose money

Ghana turned locally mined gold into foreign currency during a debt crisis. When access to external borrowing tightened, the Bank of Ghana could buy gold from local producers in cedis and export it for dollars. In 2025 it purchased and exported about 104 tonnes of artisanal and small-scale gold worth US$10.9 billion. Most of that metal passed through the programme.

EXHIBIT 07.1

Follow the gold and the cash

Ghana · 2025 mechanism and July 2026 transition

1. **Local miners** Supply partially refined gold. Purchases require cedis and quality checks.
2. **Export channel** Assaying, services and sale to buyers produce costs and foreign-currency proceeds.
3. **Bank balance sheet** Dollars can replenish reserves or finance FX sales. The exchange-rate spread affects the accounts.

The US$10.9bn measures gross artisanal exports. The US$1.7bn figure measures programme losses and uses a different accounting basis.

C13 IMF · I1 IMF

The same programme generated losses of over US$1.7 billion in 2025, equivalent to 1.5% of GDP. The IMF identifies the biggest contributor as the gap between the exchange rate used to buy the gold and the reference rate used in the bank's accounts. Assay fees, service charges and discounts to buyers added to losses. Part of the figure reflects accounting valuation; it cannot all be read as a cash loss.

GoldBod took over the programme's operations and costs in July 2026. The central bank retained a role as fiscal agent and as recipient of monetary gold for reserves. A change in who buys raw metal can therefore occur alongside continued changes in central-bank bullion holdings.

Sources C13 · I1

CHAPTER 08 / RESERVE MANAGEMENT

Why hold an asset that pays no interest?

A gold bar has no issuing government that must repay it. For a reserve manager, that feature can matter when access to foreign assets becomes uncertain. A bar held at home reduces exposure to a foreign custodian. It may still have to be moved, sold or pledged before the central bank can supply dollars to local banks. The IMF authors separate long-term reserves from the cash needed at short notice. In an illustrative two-day liquidation under stress, the IMF staff note suggests discounting the headline value by 6–12% to estimate usable liquidity.

EXHIBIT 08.1

Two uses of reserves lead to different choices

Reserve-management framework · IMF staff analysis, July 2026

Need	What the reserve manager considers
Pay USD obligations soon	Cash and readily saleable foreign assets can meet a known currency need.
Diversify a long-term portfolio	Physical gold removes issuer credit exposure but adds price volatility, custody costs and forgone interest.
Retain control under sanctions	Domestic custody can improve control. Converting those bars into usable FX can become harder under stress.

The same asset can protect against one risk and make a different risk harder to manage.

I1 IMF

More respondents expected global gold holdings to grow than expected their own bank to buy. Among respondents to the 2026 World Gold Council survey, 89% expected global official holdings to rise in the next year and 45% expected their own holdings to rise. Diversification, performance in crises and inflation protection featured in their answers. The survey records intentions. It cannot give the date or size of a trade.

EXHIBIT 08.2

Expectations differ when managers speak about their own bank

Share of respondents to each question · survey published 16 June 2026



The answers concern the following 12 months. The questions have different subjects and do not add to 100%.

G5 World Gold Council

Sources I1 · G5

CHAPTER 09 / GOLD AND US TREASURIES

A higher reserve share can come from the same bars

Gold's share of reserves can rise before a central bank buys another ounce. The IMF authors found that between 2018 and 2025 the market value of official gold rose 268%, while the physical quantity rose about 8.5%. A reserve portfolio is like a household balance sheet. If a home appreciates, property becomes a larger share of wealth even when the family buys no property.

EXHIBIT 09.1

Repricing the same end-2025 holdings changes their ranking

Share of total official reserves including gold · ECB estimates

Asset	At end-2025 prices	At end-2023 gold price
Gold	27%	16%
US Treasuries	22%	26%
Euro-denominated reserves	15%	16%

Read across each row. The ECB changed the price assigned to gold. Changing the total also changes the percentage share of the other assets. Selected assets only.

E1 European Central Bank

The ranking also changes when the investor group changes. A September Federal Reserve staff note points out that world gold includes US government gold, while foreign official Treasury holdings exclude the US. At end-2025, gold outside the US was worth US$4 trillion against US$3.9 trillion in foreign official Treasuries. By June 2026 Treasuries were ahead on that comparison even though gold ounces had increased.

Sources I1 · E1 · F1

CHAPTER 10 / THE PRICE OF GOLD

Funds bought gold in October and still lost value

Investors added US$2.7 billion to gold funds in October, yet the funds finished the month worth less. The World Gold Council's specialised ETF report shows that physical holdings rose by 19 tonnes to 4,275 tonnes, while total assets fell 6% to US$542 billion. The lower price of the metal already in the vault outweighed the value of new subscriptions.

EXHIBIT 10.1

October's three readings count different things

October 2026 · specialised ETF and derivatives report, 5 November

Observation	Change	What moved
Physical ETF holdings	+19 t	Metal held for investors
ETF assets under management	–6%	Market value of all holdings
COMEX managed-money net longs	–53 t equivalent	Futures positioning of this trader group

A fall in futures exposure does not mean 53 tonnes of bars left ETF vaults. The series use different markets and investor groups.

G4 World Gold Council

The next trade can come from a buyer with a very different deadline. OCBC's 26 October tracker found investment managers had reduced their futures exposure and that protection against a fall had grown dearer relative to upside protection. It also observed a Shanghai physical premium of about 0.9%. A wholesaler paying extra for metal and a fund selling futures to raise cash can act on the same day.

Households responded differently again. The World Gold Council's Q3 table showed bar-and-coin demand fell 19% year on year and jewellery consumption fell 17%. A higher price can discourage a wedding purchase even while an official buyer pursues a multi-year policy. The amount one group buys gives no mechanical price target for the next trade.

Sources G1 · G4 · O1

CHAPTER 11 / BANK AND AGENCY OUTLOOKS

The World Bank and the Reuters poll disagree on 2027

Two October forecasts give opposite answers to the same question. For the average gold price in 2027, the World Bank estimates US$4,250 an ounce, US$350 below its 2026 figure. The Reuters poll puts 2027 at US$4,650, US$155 above its 2026 median. The gap between their 2027 forecasts is US$400. It reflects disagreement among forecasters, rather than a trading range.

EXHIBIT 11.1

Annual-average forecasts can be compared directly

Nominal US dollars per troy ounce · October 2026 publications

Forecast owner	2026 average	2027 average	Change
World Bank	4,600	4,250	–350
Reuters poll, median	4,495	4,650	+155

Read across a row for one forecast path. Read down the 2027 column to see the US$400 disagreement. These are forecasts, not realised returns.

W1 World Bank · R2 Reuters

An annual average can fall even if gold ends the year above today's price. An average includes all the observations across the year. A high starting point or a few strong early months can lift it. Standard Chartered's targets instead describe where the bank expects gold to trade at particular horizons. Combining all these figures into a single target would answer no clear question.

EXHIBIT 11.2

Point targets answer a different question

US dollars per troy ounce · dated targets

Publisher and date	Horizon	Target
Standard Chartered · 30 Oct	Three months	4,350
Standard Chartered · 30 Oct	Twelve months	4,700
Goldman Sachs · 5 Nov, via Reuters	End-2026	4,150

The Goldman Sachs year-end target was cut from 4,650. Even a positive longer-term view can coincide with a lower near-term target.

B1 Standard Chartered · R1 Reuters

Sources W1 · R2 · B1 · R1

CHAPTER 12 / READING THE BANK PAPERS

What happened to J.P. Morgan’s US$6,000 call?

The US$6,000 forecast in the supplied paper was published on 9 June. The detailed table defined it as a Q4 2026 average. On 3 July Reuters reported a new J.P. Morgan forecast of US$4,500 for the same quarter. Comparing the same horizon gives a US$1,500 reduction, or 25%. The November date on the saved copy records when the web page was printed.

EXHIBIT 12.1

One bank, two forecasts for the same quarter

Q4 2026 average · US dollars per troy ounce · issue dates below



Bars are dated forecasts, not market prices. The revision was (4,500 – 6,000) ÷ 6,000 = –25%.

J1 J.P. Morgan · J2 Reuters

The bank’s change of mind had a stated economic reason. By July it saw softer demand from key buyers and greater sensitivity to real yields. Real yield is the return a bond offers after allowing for inflation. When that return rises, investors give up more income by holding a bar that pays no coupon. Central banks can keep accumulating gold while private investors change what they are willing to pay for it.

Sources J1 · J2 · O1

CHAPTER 13 / SINGAPORE RESERVES

MAS rebuilt some of the gold it had trimmed

Singapore's reported gold rose by 323,268 fine troy ounces in the first nine months of 2026. That reverses the direction of the two preceding year-end changes. The September balance remained below December 2024. Describing this as a partial rebuild fits the series. It also avoids guessing at MAS's preferred entry price or the reason for each adjustment.

EXHIBIT 13.1

Gold on Singapore's official reserve return

Fine troy ounces · I.A(4), period end

Observation	Reported volume	Change from prior row
Dec 2023	7,395,505	—
Dec 2024	7,072,034	–323,471
Dec 2025	6,223,213	–848,821
Sep 2026, preliminary	6,546,481	+323,268

The last step covers nine months. These are changes between reported balances. They do not show individual trade dates or sale proceeds.

M4 Monetary Authority of Singapore · M3 Monetary Authority of Singapore · M2 Monetary Authority of Singapore · M1 Monetary Authority of Singapore

MAS gives readers both an accounting value and a physical volume. Its September return shows US$6,223.50 million for gold on its published book-value basis and separately lists 6,546,481 fine troy ounces. Using the ounce line avoids turning accounting changes into assumed purchases. The category includes gold deposits and, where appropriate, swapped gold.

Sources M4 · M3 · M2 · M1

CHAPTER 14 / THE SINGAPORE INVESTOR

Translate the gold return into the currency you spend

A Singapore investor who owns unhedged gold has two prices to watch. XAU/USD quotes the US dollars needed to buy one troy ounce. USD/SGD quotes the Singapore dollars needed to buy one US dollar. Multiply the two at the same time to get Singapore dollars per ounce. A stronger Singapore dollar means each US dollar of gold proceeds converts into fewer Singapore dollars.

EXHIBIT 14.1

From two market quotes to a Singapore-dollar return

Unhedged exposure · same quantity · before dealing costs

1. **Entry value per ounce** Entry XAU/USD × entry USD/SGD.
2. **Exit value per ounce** Exit XAU/USD × exit USD/SGD.
3. **Gross SGD return** (Exit SGD value ÷ entry SGD value – 1) × 100%.

For an actual cash return, compare SGD paid including fees with SGD received net of sale costs. A currency-hedged share class follows a different calculation.

H1 Market Intelligence Hub

Use the actual instrument and matching timestamps at both ends. A physical bar has a dealer spread and may carry storage costs. An ETF has a fee and its trading price can differ from the value of its gold. A derivatives contract can add collateral, leverage or rolling costs. The earlier Hub study traced XAU39344-USD to a derivatives listing. Joining that series to a spot quote would give a misleading return.

EXHIBIT 14.2

How the currency leg changes the outcome

Unhedged holding · direction only

Gold in USD	USD/SGD	What it means in SGD
Rises	Rises	Both price moves help.
Rises	Falls	FX can reduce, erase or reverse the gold gain.
Flat	Falls	SGD gold loses value before costs.

USD/SGD falls when the Singapore dollar strengthens against the US dollar. The HTML calculator accepts your own two dated gold and FX quotes.

H1 Market Intelligence Hub

Sources H1 · M1

CHAPTER 15 / PORTFOLIO DECISIONS

What would change the investment case?

Choose the reason for holding gold before choosing an entry. If the objective is long-term diversification, ask whether the position still helps when it loses value at the same time as shares. If the objective is a short trade, the price of money, the US dollar and leveraged positioning can matter sooner than the next quarterly reserve release. A cash need in SGD requires a separate currency and liquidity decision.

EXHIBIT 15.1

Three possible paths and the evidence to watch

Conditional scenarios as at 6 November 2026 · no assigned probabilities

Scenario	What to look for	Decision to revisit
Support broadens	Real yields ease, the dollar softens and physical ETF holdings keep rising.	Check whether the price recovery also reaches the SGD investor.
Gold trades sideways	Official demand persists while private investors disagree and yields stay high.	Revisit the holding horizon and the income forgone on cash or bonds.
A cash squeeze	Futures longs shrink, ETF holdings roll over or a stronger dollar tightens liquidity.	Check funding needs, available cash and tolerance for an interim loss.

Read each row as a combination of signals. A single data point, including a central-bank release, cannot confirm an entry price.

O1 OCBC · G4 World Gold Council · I1 IMF · B1 Standard Chartered

A useful test is to specify what would change your mind. A stronger dollar and rising real yields can pressure gold even as official demand holds up. Conversely, easier real yields and persistent investment inflows can support a recovery. These are conditional paths. Data observed together can support a narrative without proving which trade moved the price.

EXHIBIT 15.2

What to check next

Monitoring schedule · research framework

When	Series	What would matter
Daily	Gold spot, real yields, USD/SGD	Compare synchronised observations and the price of the instrument held.
Monthly	ETF holdings and national reserve volumes	Distinguish physical additions from valuation and currency effects.
Quarterly	WGC demand, estimate revisions, bank outlooks	Rebuild the series from one release and compare targets with the same horizon.

Keep the observation date beside every number. A target being reached, or a forecast being cut, is a reason to revisit its contribution.

G1 World Gold Council / Metals Focus · G3 World Gold Council / IMF IFS / national authorities · G4 World Gold Council · B1 Standard Chartered

CHAPTER 16 / READING GUIDE

Which research paper answers which question?

The most useful papers look at different parts of the gold market. The IMF authors study what a reserve manager can do with bullion in a crisis. The ECB and Federal Reserve papers test how much of the rise in gold's reported importance comes from prices and existing holdings. Bank outlooks focus more closely on the marginal buyer and the next few quarters.

EXHIBIT 16.1

A reading list by research question

Selected publisher papers · 2026

Read this for…	Primary paper	Where to start
How quickly bars can become usable cash	IMF · Gold in Central Bank Reserves	Liquidity and custody sections
How a domestic purchase scheme works	IMF · Lessons from Ghana	Figures 5–7 and printed pp. 5–8
Whether gold displaced Treasuries	ECB · International role of the euro / FEDS Notes	ECB chart 7 / Fed figures 1–3
A baseline for annual gold prices	World Bank · Commodity Markets Outlook	Table 1 and pp. 46–47
Near-term pricing pressure and target revisions	OCBC tracker / Standard Chartered / J.P. Morgan	OCBC pp. 1–3 / SC p. 15 / JPM forecast table

Use issuer disclosures for country-specific motives, researcher analysis for mechanisms and dated forecasts for expectations. The source directory links each paper or its publisher.

I1 IMF · E1 European Central Bank · F1 Federal Reserve · W1 World Bank · O1 OCBC · B1 Standard Chartered · J1 J.P. Morgan · J3 J.P. Morgan · C13 IMF

The silver and renminbi papers help define the limits of the gold argument. J.P. Morgan's silver research discusses solar manufacturers reducing silver use. That industrial channel is much less central to the official gold story. OCBC's November renminbi note concerns its currency outlook, and its sustainability weekly covers other policy developments. Neither establishes the identity of an undisclosed gold buyer.

Sources I1 · E1 · F1 · W1 · O1 · B1 · J1 · J3

REFERENCE REGISTER

Sources and further reading

Select a publication title to open the source. Page and exhibit references identify the evidence used in the report.

G1
Gold Demand Trends, Q3 2026
World Gold Council, Metals Focus and contributors · 3 Nov 2026
Table 1. Revised quarterly quantities through 30 September.

G2
Central banks and other official institutions
World Gold Council and Metals Focus · 3 Nov 2026
Q3 disclosures captured to 30 October. See notes 1–4 for coverage.

G3
Central Bank Gold Statistics, September 2026
World Gold Council, IMF IFS and national authorities · 4 Nov 2026
September and year-to-date reported changes. Monthly totals exclude quarterly-only SOFAZ.

G4
Gold ETF Flows, October 2026
World Gold Council · 5 Nov 2026
Monthly fund report through 31 October. ETF flows, holdings, AUM and COMEX positioning.

G5
Central Bank Gold Reserves Survey 2026
World Gold Council · 16 Jun 2026
Survey fielded 5 February–19 May. A total of 76 responses, with bases varying by question.

G6
Gold Demand Trends, Q2 2026
World Gold Council and Metals Focus · Jul 2026
Historical release. Explains the Q1 demand revision and movement in Türkiye.

G7
Gold Demand Trends, Q1 2026
World Gold Council · 29 Apr 2026
First Q1 release. Retained to document the original estimate.

I1
Gold in Central Bank Reserves
IMF Notes 2026/007, Istvan Mak and Etienne Vaccaro-Grange · 9 Jul 2026
Printed p. 6, figure 2 and sections on hedging, custody and liquidity. Authors' analysis.

REFERENCE REGISTER

Sources and further reading · continued

E1
The international role of the euro
European Central Bank · Jun 2026
Printed pp. 14–15, chart 7a and accompanying text. End-2025 reserve shares under two price bases.

F1
Why Gold Didn't Actually Overtake Treasury Securities as the World's "Favorite" Reserve Asset
Federal Reserve Board, FEDS Notes, Colin Weiss · 3 Sep 2026
Figures 1–3 and appendix. Author's findings on valuation, legacy reserves and investor coverage.

W1
Commodity Markets Outlook, October 2026
World Bank · Oct 2026
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